



A Republic Requires Readers

WisdomForge Booklet — Ages 15–18

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About This Book

This booklet is the six live sittings called *Citizens — Constitution & Declaration*. Those sittings are already on the academy for young, emerging, and adult. There is no little sitting. Little `/learn/little/history/words-before-story` is **404** by design. This high band is the emerging sitting, with the young sitting in the room so you can see the earlier seat. It is not the Hour book *History for Homeschooling*. It is not the civic *figure* packs (Federalist, Magna Carta, Constitution, Declaration, Fourteenth). Those remain their own products. This spine is six practices: read the words first, audit the Declaration as an argument, see the Constitution as a design, find a missing voice in a real text, treat amendment as civic practice, and run the full cycle once on paper.

A grown-up is in the room. Synthetic names only. No real family data. We read real words from the founding documents. We do not skip the ugly parts. We do not preach. We read.

The six sittings already live (young+): ``words-before-story``, ``declaration-rhetoric``, ``constitution-design``, ``missing-voices-founding``, ``amendment-process``, ``citizens-capstone``. Sitting 1 is `/learn/emerging/history/words-before-story` for this band; the young page is `/learn/young/history/words-before-story`. This booklet does not replace them. It is the text beside the sitting.

Hard rule: the object is the page. Recaps, videos, and model summaries come second. If the page was not opened, the sitting did not happen. If the ugly clause was skipped while the pretty sentence was framed on the wall, the sitting did not happen either. Look first. The document is the source.

You already know how to sound like you read. This pack is annoying on purpose. It asks for a paragraph written without interpretation before the story about the paragraph. If you only do that in a chat with a model, you did a worksheet for a machine.

Young sitting, same law, smaller page: one sentence, write what it says, catch one add and one drop. Adult sitting: one page at the table, including the ugly clause when you reach it. You are in the middle seat. Do the paragraph. Name three additions or deletions. Then read one ugly clause and ask whether it was in the summary.

“We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.” — Declaration of Independence (1776)

Chapter 1: Primary Text, Not Storybook



A republic requires citizens who have read the documents. Not summaries of the documents. The documents.

Objective. The student can read a paragraph from the Declaration or Constitution, write what it says without interpretation, compare it to a model summary, and name three additions or deletions.

For the grown-up in the room. Do not let the student skip the reading. The reading is the sitting. The Constitution contains the three-fifths clause and the fugitive slave clause. When you reach them, read them. Do not skip. Name what they are. Do not sermonize. Grade whether they wrote what the paragraph says, not whether they love 1787.

This sitting builds on the young version. The student reads a full paragraph from a founding document, writes what it says without interpretation, then compares to a model summary. The skill is the same as *Source Before Summary*, applied to civic text. The student who can read a paragraph and name what a summary added or dropped has learned that even civic text gets compressed, and the compression is not neutral.

A republic is a moral practice. The Declaration is about 1,300 words. The Constitution is about 4,500. Both are shorter than a textbook chapter about them. The citizen who reads the documents has read the source. The citizen who reads the summary has read someone's compression. The compression chooses. It keeps some things and drops others. Sometimes it drops the ugly parts. Sometimes it drops the surprising parts. You will not notice the drop if you never saw the page.

The Constitution contains the three-fifths clause: enslaved people counted as three-fifths of a person for representation. It contains the fugitive slave clause: escaped enslaved people must be returned. These clauses are in the document. They are not in most summaries. They are not in most storybook versions of the founding. The citizen who reads the Constitution and finds these clauses has read the real document. The citizen who reads a summary that dropped them has read a cleaned-up version.

“Representatives and direct Taxes shall be apportioned among the several States which may be included within this Union, according to their respective Numbers, which shall be determined by adding to the whole Number of free Persons, including those bound to Service for a Term of Years, and excluding Indians not taxed, three fifths of all other Persons.” — Constitution of the United States, Article I, Section 2

“No Person held to Service or Labour in one State, under the Laws thereof, escaping into another, shall, in Consequence of any Law or Regulation therein, be discharged

from such Service or Labour, but shall be delivered up on Claim of the Party to whom such Service or Labour may be due.” — Constitution of the United States, Article IV, Section 2

Read them. Write what they say. Ask: was this in the summary? If the summary sang “We the People” and never mentioned these sentences, that is not a small omission. That is a different product.

Young sitting, same law. Before a textbook tells you what the Founders meant, read what they wrote. Write what the sentence says. Then read a summary. What did it add? What did it drop? “All men” did not mean all people. Write that. The gap is the lesson. Do not cite a model summary as the source. The words are the source. If they say “I know what the Declaration says”: you might know a recap. Read the actual words. If they say “The Founders were hypocrites”: some were. Read the words and name the gap. “Hypocrites” without the words is a slogan.

Adult sitting, same law. The adult models reading the document. Not a recap. One page of the Declaration or Constitution. Write what it says. Do not interpret. Do not add. Then, if you want, read a summary. Compare. The child who sees an adult read the source first learns that citizens read the document. The child who sees an adult argue from a recap learns that citizens argue from summaries. The reading is the inheritance. If they say “They won’t understand the old language”: they will understand more than you think. The language is old, not opaque. If they say “I don’t want to read the ugly parts with my child”: then the child learns that citizenship skips the ugly parts. That is propaganda.

Pauline Maier’s *American Scripture* (1997) is the scholarly reminder that the Declaration was not treated as holy writ in 1776. It was a political instrument that became scripture later. You do not need Maier to pass this sitting. You need the paragraph. The debate is useful only as a warning: reverence can arrive before reading, and then the reading never happens. Danielle Allen’s *Our Declaration* (2014) is a slow reading of political equality in the sentence you already know. Slow is the point. Fluency is the enemy.

Carl Becker’s older history-of-ideas reading and Maier’s political-document reading are not a test question. They mark a live disagreement: is the Declaration primarily a chapter in European natural-rights thought, or primarily a wartime instrument that later generations turned into a creed? If you only know the creed, you have Maier’s later scripture and not 1776’s job. If you only know the wartime instrument, you miss why Douglass and Lincoln could pick the sentence up as a standard. Both jobs are on the page. The sitting is to see that a summary usually keeps only one.

A second live fight sits behind “self-evident.” Allen argues that the sentence is an achievement of political equality that still has to be practiced, not a magic that finished in 1776. A cynical reading treats “self-evident” as a bluff. An honest reading treats it as a claim that can be audited: who was counted, who was not, and what later text tried to close the gap. You can hold Allen’s slow equality and still name three-fifths in the same week. That pairing is the citizenship. The pairing a feed will not do for you.

Young’s dinner is still in force: what words did we read, and what did the summary miss? Emerging’s dinner is the longer version of the same question. Do not swap them for a vibe about patriotism.

If they say “The summary is easier to understand.”: It is. It is also someone else’s choices about what to keep. The document is the source. The summary is the compression. Read the source first. Use the summary as a comparison, not a replacement.

If they say “The ugly clauses are in the past.”: They are in the document. The document is the foundation of the republic. The citizen who does not know what is in the foundation does not know what they are standing on. Read it. Name it. The naming is not guilt. It is literacy.

The Big Idea. A republic requires citizens who read the documents. Not summaries. The ugly clauses are in the document. Read them.

Integrity. Cite the document. Do not cite the model summary as the source. The document is the source. The summary is a compression. Label both.

Dinner. What did the founding document say this week that the summary did not?

Practice

1. Read the preamble to the Constitution. Write what it says, without interpretation. 2. Ask the model to summarize the preamble. Save the summary. 3. Compare: what did the summary add? Drop? Change? Write three additions or deletions. 4. Now read one ugly clause (three-fifths or fugitive slave). Write what it says. Ask: was this in the summary? 5. After the comparison, ask the model: “What did you drop?” If it names the drop, that is honest. If it says it captured the essence, that is a dodge.

Reflect

What does a cleaned-up summary miss that the document has — and why might a school, a feed, or a model prefer the cleaned-up version?

Chapter 2: The Declaration as Argument



Illustration for Chapter 2

The Declaration is an argument: a claim (we have the right to independence), evidence (the list of grievances), and a conclusion (we are independent). Audit it.

Objective. The student can deconstruct the Declaration into claim, evidence, and conclusion, evaluate the strength of the evidence, and name one weakness in the argument.

For the grown-up in the room. Do not make this a takedown of the Declaration. The point is the audit, not the verdict. The audit might find the argument strong. The grievances include exaggerations and omissions. Name them. The naming is the audit. If they call it sacred, let them keep the feeling and still do the audit. If they call it propaganda, make them show the work.

The Declaration has a structure. It opens with a claim: when a government destroys rights, the people may abolish it. It provides evidence: a list of grievances against the King. It concludes: therefore, we are independent. The structure is an argument. The citizen who can see the structure can audit it. Is the claim justified? Is the evidence sufficient? Are the grievances accurate? Some grievances are specific and verifiable. Others are vague and rhetorical. Some are exaggerated for effect. That mix is ordinary political speech. Naming the mix is the sitting. Pretending every line is either gospel or fraud is not.

The Declaration says “all men are created equal.” It was written by men, some of whom enslaved people. It did not include women, Indigenous people, or the enslaved. The argument claims universality. The reality was partial. That gap is not a reason to dismiss the Declaration. It is a reason to read it honestly. The citizen who can say “the argument claims equality, the reality was partial, and the gap is the history” has read the Declaration as a citizen, not as a fan or a critic. Both the argument and the gap are the document.

“When in the Course of human events, it becomes necessary for one people to dissolve the political bands which have connected them with another...” — Declaration of Independence, opening

That sentence is ethos: we claim the standing to act. Pathos sits in the appeal to “the Supreme Judge of the world” and “the opinions of mankind.” Logos sits in the list: “He has refused... He has forbidden... He has obstructed...” A list is not automatically a proof. Ask of each grievance: specific? verifiable? rhetorical weather?

Young sitting, same speech, smaller ask. Identify one example of ethos, pathos, and logos and explain how each appeal works. The model can summarize the Declaration. It cannot analyze the appeals unless asked. The student asks. The analysis is the citizenship. Do it first, then check. Do not reduce the Declaration to a rhetoric exercise. It is also a historical document. The rhetoric is one lens, not the only one. If they say “It’s just an old document”: it is a speech that uses the same appeals every speech uses. Hearing the jobs is how you see how it works.

Adult sitting. Read the Declaration aloud at the table. The whole thing. About 1,300 words. Ten minutes. Name one appeal and one weakness. Stop. If the child asks about “all men,” answer honestly. Do not dodge. If they say it is too long: it is shorter than many bedtime stories. The hearing is the lesson even if they do not catch every word.

Carl Becker treated the Declaration as a document in the history of ideas; Pauline Maier treated it as a political act that later became American scripture. You do not have to pick a team. You have to refuse the move that says “sacred, therefore unauditible” or “old, therefore trash.” Garry Wills’s work on Lincoln and the Declaration is the later story: 1863 re-reads 1776. Stay with 1776’s own structure first. Then hear how later readers used it.

“Four score and seven years ago our fathers brought forth on this continent, a new nation, conceived in Liberty, and dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal.” — Abraham Lincoln, Gettysburg Address (19 November 1863)

Lincoln does not quote the Constitution’s three-fifths clause. He quotes the Declaration’s proposition. That is a choice. Wills and others argue that Lincoln pulled the nation’s center of gravity from 1787’s compact toward 1776’s claim. You do not have to accept that as the only reading. You do have to notice that a wartime president used the Declaration as a standard the Constitution had not yet kept. Douglass, eleven years earlier, had already used the same standard from the other side of the color line. The later use does not erase the first room. It names the gap and keeps the sentence.

A scholarly objection worth keeping: some grievances against the King are conventional Whig charges, recycled from earlier colonial protests, not a forensic brief. That does not make the Declaration a lie. It makes the logos mixed. Mixed logos is ordinary political speech. If you need every line to be either gospel or fraud, you are not auditing. You are picking a jersey.

If they say “It’s a sacred document.”: It is a document. Sacred is a feeling about it. The audit is a reading of it. You can revere the document and audit it. The reverence without the audit is faith. The audit without the reverence is cynicism. Both together is citizenship.

If they say “It’s just propaganda.”: It is an argument. Propaganda does not invite audit. The Declaration does: it lists its evidence and invites the world to judge. The audit is the response to that invitation. If you call it propaganda without auditing it, you have only swapped slogans.

The Big Idea. The Declaration is an argument. Audit it: claim, evidence, conclusion. Name the strengths, the weaknesses, and the missing voices.

Integrity. Cite the document. Name the strengths and the weaknesses. The honest audit is the citizenship. The one-sided audit is propaganda in the other direction.

Dinner. What did we find when we audited the Declaration this week?

Practice

1. Read the Declaration. Deconstruct: CLAIM / EVIDENCE / CONCLUSION. 2. Evaluate the evidence: are the grievances specific? Verifiable? Exaggerated? 3. Name one strength: which grievances are strong? 4. Name one weakness: which are vague or rhetorical? 5. Name the missing voices: who is not in the “all men”? 6. Find ethos, pathos, logos on the page *before* asking a model. Then check. Cite the model if you used it.

Reflect

Can you revere a document and still name a weak grievance in the same sitting — and if you cannot, which of those two jobs have you decided is forbidden?

Chapter 3: The Constitution as Design



Illustration for Chapter 3

The Constitution is architecture: separation, checks, amendment. See the design. Name the tensions. The understanding is the citizenship.

Objective. The student can describe the Constitution’s architecture (separation of powers, checks and balances, amendment process), identify one design tension, and explain why the design matters for citizenship.

For the grown-up in the room. One article is enough if time is short; Articles I–III if you have the hour. Name one design feature and one tension. Do not sermonize. Do not skip three-fifths. If they already “know the three branches,” ask *why three*. The list is school. The why is the sitting.

Someone writes laws. Someone carries them out. Someone judges them. Legislative, executive, judicial — Article I, Article II, Article III. Each can stop the others. A veto. An override. A court. Advice and consent. The people who wrote it had seen a king with too many hands on the wheel. They did not trust one pile of power. The design is the distrust made into a machine.

A list of branch names is memorization. A student who can say *why three* has begun to see the design. A talking tool will happily list the branches. Ask it to explain the design, not the list. If it only lists, that is the lesson. The model can summarize the design. It cannot understand it for you. The understanding is yours. Read the articles. Then check with the model. The order matters.

The design matters because it is the structure of your government. The citizen who does not understand the structure cannot evaluate whether it is working. Is the balance of power holding? Are the checks functioning? Is the amendment process accessible? These are civic questions. They require understanding the design. The citizen who can say “the design separates power because...” has started to practice. The citizen who can only recite “legislative, executive, judicial” has memorized a poster.

The design includes an ugly bargain. Three-fifths. Fugitive slave. Brilliant design. Ugly price. Both are the Constitution. Skipping the bargain is a cleaned-up story. We do not clean it up.

*“We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America.” —
Constitution of the United States, Preamble*

“More perfect” is a design phrase. It admits the union is not finished. Article V is the other half of that admission. You will open Article V in chapter 5. Tonight, stay with the three jobs, one check, and one bargain.

Young sitting, same machine. Three cards: WRITE LAWS, CARRY OUT, JUDGE. One acted check. Grown-up says, plainly: enslaved people were counted as three-fifths and could not vote. That is in the design. It is ugly. It is ours to name. If they say “I know the three branches”: you know the list. Do you know the design?

Adult sitting. Read one article of the Constitution with the child. Article I, II, or III. Name one design feature: “Congress makes laws. The President carries them out. The courts judge them. This is a design so that no one has all the power.” Name one tension: “The three-fifths clause was a compromise with slavery. It is in the design. It is ugly.” The child who never sees this learns that the Constitution is a symbol, not a design. The symbol without the design is decoration.

Gordon Wood’s *The Creation of the American Republic* treats 1787 as a republican experiment in distributing power. Charles Beard’s *An Economic Interpretation of the Constitution* (1913) treats it as an economic bargain among holders of specific interests. You do not have to become a Beardian or a Woodian in one sitting. You have to refuse the cleaned-up story that the design was only marble and never a deal. Akhil Reed Amar reads the Constitution as a document of popular sovereignty that later amendments keep trying to make true. Name the fight. Do not outsource the verdict to a recap.

A third live disagreement sits on judicial review. The Constitution does not use the phrase. *Marbury v. Madison* (1803) is the Court naming a power for itself. Civic figure packs treat that as its own sitting on the Constitution spine. This unit’s job is smaller and earlier: see that the design separates jobs, and that later practice can add a check the first text did not spell. Do not steal the Constitution figure booklet. Do name that “the design” includes both the 1787 text and the later machine.

Madison in Federalist No. 51 argued that ambition must counteract ambition. That essay is the Federalist figure pack, already gold. You may hear the sentence as a design principle without converting that pack: the Constitution does not trust virtue alone. It sets power against power. If your summary of the Constitution is only “freedom” and never “distrust,” the summary dropped the machine.

Young still needs the three cards. Emerging needs the why. Adult needs one article at the table. If you skip the why because you already passed a quiz on branch names, you did the young list in a high-school costume.

If they say “The Constitution is outdated.”: Parts of it are. The design includes an amendment process for that reason. The citizen who says “it’s outdated” without understanding the design is complaining. The citizen who understands the design and uses the amendment process is participating. Both are allowed. Only one is citizenship.

If they say “The original Constitution was fine.”: It included slavery. It excluded women. It counted enslaved people as three-fifths. The amendments fixed parts of that. Read both.

The Big Idea. The Constitution is a design: who has power, who checks it, who can change it. The design is clever. The bargains can be ugly. Read both.

Integrity. Name the tension. If you only name the brilliance, the reading is propaganda. If you only name the ugliness, the reading is cynicism. Both is the citizenship.

Dinner. What article did we read this week, and what did the design show us?

Practice

1. Read Article I, II, or III. Write the job of that article in one sentence. 2. Name one check that article can run or suffer. 3. Write the three-fifths clause in your own hand. No speech. What it says. 4. Ask the model to “explain the Constitution.” Did it mention three-fifths or the fugitive slave clause? Record the drop. 5. One design tension of your own: not a slogan. A sentence that could be false.

Reflect

If a summary of the Constitution never mentions three-fifths, is it a bad summary or a different product — and which one are you willing to call the source?

Chapter 4: The Founding and the Missing



Illustration for Chapter 4

The founding documents claim universality and were written by a partial room. The gap between the claim and the room is not a footnote. It is the central tension of the republic.

Objective. The student can identify the gap between the founding documents' universal claims and their partial authorship, name two missing voices, and find one real source for a missing voice.

For the grown-up in the room. Do not reduce the founding to its gaps. The point is reading both the document and the gap. Academic integrity: cite the real source for the missing voice, not the model. The model is not a voice. Choose a text the student can finish: Adams's letter is one page; a Douglass excerpt is enough; a treaty or speech with a date and a speaker is enough. Do not ask the model to speak for the dead.

The Declaration claims that all men are created equal and are endowed with unalienable rights. The claim is universal. The room that wrote it was not. The room had no women, no enslaved people, no Indigenous people, no people without property. The gap between the universal claim and the partial room is not a contradiction to resolve in a slogan. It is the central tension of the republic. The republic has spent two and a half centuries trying to make the universal claim match the room. The amendments that ended slavery, granted birthright citizenship, and widened the vote are that attempt, not a separate story.

The missing voices have real texts. Frederick Douglass's "What to the Slave Is the Fourth of July?" is a missing voice speaking back to the founding. Abigail Adams's "Remember the Ladies" letter is a missing voice speaking to the room in the same year as independence. Indigenous speeches and treaties are missing voices speaking to the republic. The student who finds one of these texts and reads it alongside the founding has completed the cycle: read the words, name the gap, find the missing voice, compare. The model cannot provide the missing voice. The student finds it in a real text.

"I desire you would Remember the Ladies, and be more generous and favourable to them than your ancestors. Do not put such unlimited power into the hands of the Husbands." — Abigail Adams to John Adams, 31 March 1776

"What, to the American slave, is your 4th of July? I answer; a day that reveals to him, more than all other days in the year, the gross injustice and cruelty to which he is the constant victim." — Frederick Douglass, "What to the Slave Is the Fourth of July?" (Rochester, 5 July 1852)

Douglass did not reject the Declaration. He used it. He held the nation to its own standard. That is the other half of the republic, not a cancellation of the first half. "Products of their time" is not an eraser. The missing voices were also products of their time, and they said so. Douglass said it in 1852. Adams said it in 1776. Indigenous leaders said it in treaties and speeches.

Young sitting, seating chart. Name one group who was not in the room and say the paper would have been different if they had been. Draw the table. Point at the empty chairs. If they say “That was a long time ago”: it is in the paper we still use. Old is not the same as gone. If they say “Then the paper is bad”: the paper claimed a promise and broke it in the same room. Throwing the paper away without reading it is another skip. If they say “We can’t judge the past by today’s standards”: this is not judgment. This is reading. The room did not include everyone. That is a fact.

Adult sitting. Read one missing-voice text alongside a founding document. Names the gap. Says: “The founding said this. The missing voice says this. Both are the republic.” The child who hears only the founding has received half. If they fear guilt: this is not about guilt. It is about completeness. Literacy is not a feeling.

Thurgood Marshall, speaking on the bicentennial of the Constitution (6 May 1987), refused the story that the meaning was forever fixed in Philadelphia:

“I do not believe that the meaning of the Constitution was forever ‘fixed’ at the Philadelphia Convention. Nor do I find the wisdom, foresight, and sense of justice exhibited by the Framers particularly profound. To the contrary, the government they devised was defective from the start, requiring several amendments, a civil war, and momentous social transformation to attain the system of constitutional government, and its respect for the individual freedoms and human rights, we hold as fundamental today.” — Thurgood Marshall, speech at the Annual Seminar of the San Francisco Patent and Trademark Law Association, Maui, 6 May 1987

The sitting does not need you to become a Marshall scholar. It needs you to notice that a Supreme Court justice treated the founding as defective and unfinished, and still took the oath. Defective and unfinished is not “trash it.” It is “read it, including the later pages.” A bicentennial celebration that cannot hear this paragraph is a party, not a reading.

A second missing-voice discipline: do not let a model invent an Indigenous speech. Treaties and council records exist. If you cannot walk to a named text with a date, you do not yet have the voice. “The model said Native people were excluded” is a summary of a fact you already have from the seating chart. It is not the voice. The voice is a speaker, a date, a document. Same rule as Douglass. Same rule as Adams.

Young’s seating chart is still required. Emerging’s source hunt is the new work. If you name two groups and never open a real text, you did the young sitting in harder vocabulary. The model is not a workaround for the library.

If they say “The Founders were products of their time.”: They were. The missing voices were also products of their time, and they said so. “Products of their time” is not an excuse to skip the people who were also of that time.

If they say “I can just ask the model what the missing voices said.”: You can ask for a summary. The summary is not the voice. Read the actual text: Douglass’s speech, Adams’s letter, the treaty. The model summarizes. The text speaks. Read the text.

The Big Idea. The founding claims universality and was written by a partial room. The gap is the central tension. Find the missing voices. Read them.

Integrity. Cite the real text for the missing voice. Do not cite the model as the source for the voice. The model is a summary. The text is the voice.

Dinner. What missing voice did we find this week, and what did it say back to the founding?

Practice

1. Read the opening of the Declaration. Name the universal claim. 2. Name the room: who was in it? Who was not? 3. Name two missing voices: women, enslaved people, Indigenous people, people without property. 4. Find one real text from a missing voice: Douglass, Adams, an Indigenous speech or treaty, or another dated source. Write a sentence it actually says. Cite it. 5. Put the founding sentence and the missing-voice sentence on the same page. Do not pick a winner. Name the gap.

Research Prompt

Read a continuous excerpt of Douglass’s Rochester speech (5 July 1852) — not a quotation card — and write ten lines on how he *uses* the Declaration rather than discarding it. Cite the speech. Do not cite a model as Douglass.

Chapter 5: Amendment as Civic Practice



Illustration for Chapter 5

The amendment process is the design feature that lets the republic evolve without breaking. The 13th, 14th, and 19th amendments are the republic changing its mind.

Objective. The student can describe the amendment process, name three amendments that changed the republic, and explain how amendment connects to the founding's promise of change.

For the grown-up in the room. Do not reduce amendments to a timeline. The point is the practice: the republic changing its design. Academic integrity: cite the amendments. Do not cite a model summary as the source. The Fourteenth is its own figure booklet. Point at it. Do not convert it. One Reconstruction amendment on the table is enough if you also name the other two.

The Declaration promised that all men are created equal. The Constitution designed a government. The promise was not kept by the design. Slavery was in the design. Women could not vote. The amendment process was the design feature that let the republic try to keep the promise. The 13th amendment ended slavery. The 14th gave citizenship to all people born in the United States. The 15th gave voting rights regardless of race. The 19th gave women the vote. The 26th lowered the voting age. Each amendment was a change to the design, made by the people, through the process the designers built. See amendment as the republic evolving, not as a list of dates.

The amendments reveal the gap between the founding's promise and its reality, and the republic's attempt to close the gap. The 13th amendment reveals that slavery was in the original design. The 14th reveals that citizenship was not originally universal. The 19th reveals that women were not originally included. Each amendment is a correction. The citizen who reads the amendments alongside the original design sees both: the design was brilliant and partial. The amendments are the republic trying to keep a promise the first room did not keep.

“The Congress, whenever two thirds of both Houses shall deem it necessary, shall propose Amendments to this Constitution, or, on the Application of the Legislatures of two thirds of the several States, shall call a Convention for proposing Amendments...”
— *Constitution of the United States, Article V*

Hard on purpose. Many hands. Not one king. The designers made change difficult so that it requires broad agreement, not a narrow majority. The difficulty is a feature, not a bug. 27 amendments have passed. The difficulty is not impossibility.

“Neither slavery nor involuntary servitude, except as a punishment for crime whereof the party shall have been duly convicted, shall exist within the United States, or any place subject to their jurisdiction.” — Amendment XIII (1865)

“All persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of the United States and of the State wherein they reside.” — Amendment XIV, Section 1 (1868)

That sentence is the citizenship clause. Read it once. Then leave the rest of the Fourteenth to its own six sittings. Do not turn tonight into that pack.

“The right of citizens of the United States to vote shall not be denied or abridged by the United States or by any State on account of sex.” — Amendment XIX (1920)

| Change | What the words do | What they admit | |---|---|---| | Article V | How the paper changes | 1787 was not finished | | Amendment XIII | Ends slavery as a constitutional fact | Slavery was in the design | | Amendment XIV §1 | Birthright citizenship | Citizenship was not originally universal | | Amendment XIX | Votes may not be denied on account of sex | The original room left women out |

Young sitting. Explain what an amendment is, name one that changed the republic, describe how the document can change. Two papers: “1787” and “later.” One amendment on “later.” If they say it is set in stone: read Article V. If they say changing it is too hard: hard is the design. A king’s pen is easy.

Adult sitting. Read one amendment with the child. Name the gap it closed. “The 13th amendment ended slavery. Slavery was in the original design. The amendment changed the design.” The child who only hears the original Constitution learns it is a relic. The amendment is the proof that the republic is alive.

If they say “Amendments are too hard to pass.”: They are hard by design. The difficulty is a feature. But 27 have passed.

If they say “The original Constitution was fine.”: It included slavery. It excluded women. It counted enslaved people as three-fifths. The citizen who says “fine” without reading the amendments has not read the gaps. Read both.

If they say “We should just write a new one.”: Then you still have to agree. Article V is one path for agreeing. Walking away from every path is not a new constitution. It is leaving the table.

A live scholarly fight on Article V is whether the convention route is a safety valve or a loaded weapon. You do not need to settle it. You need to see that the text names two paths — Congress proposes, or states call a convention — and that almost all successful amendments have used the first. “Too hard” is often a complaint about the first path’s

supermajorities. “Too dangerous” is often a fear of the second. Both complaints are about design, not about vibes. Write which path you are talking about before you talk.

The Reconstruction amendments (13, 14, 15) are the republic changing its mind after a war. The 19th is the republic changing its mind after a half-century of organized argument. The 26th is the republic changing its mind about age during another war. None of those stories is a timeline poster. Each is a gap-plus-correction. If you only memorize numbers, you have trivia. If you can say what gap a numbered amendment closed, you have the sitting.

Young still gets one amendment in five sentences. Emerging gets three and the process. Adult gets one amendment at the table and the gap it closed. Do not steal the Fourteenth figure pack because §1 is sitting on this page. Point and leave.

The Big Idea. Amendment is the republic changing its design to match its promise. The 13th, 14th, and 19th are the republic changing its mind.

Integrity. Cite the amendments. Read them. Do not present a model summary as the source. The text is the source.

Dinner. What amendments did we read this week, and what gaps did they close?

Practice

1. Read Article V. Describe the amendment process in your own words. Who has to agree? 2. Read the 13th, 14th §1, and 19th. They are short. Copy one sentence from each in your hand. 3. For each, write the gap it closed in one sentence. 4. Name one gap an amendment did *not* close. Do not invent a sermon. Name a limit. 5. If you mention the Fourteenth beyond §1, stop and open the figure booklet instead of this one.

Reflect

Is “too hard to change” a complaint about the design, or a confession that you have not yet named who would have to agree?

Chapter 6: The Citizen's Full Practice



Illustration for Chapter 6

Read the words, see the design, name the missing voices, understand amendment, and act.
The full practice of citizenship in one cycle.

Objective. The student can run the full citizenship cycle: read a founding document, audit the design, name the missing voices, connect to an amendment, and name one citizen act they will take.

For the grown-up in the room. The student must run every step. Skipping is skipping the capstone. The citizen act must be real. “Vote” if they can. “Read” if they cannot. “Speak” is always available. Do not name an act they will not do. The honesty is the citizenship. Mark done only if they read actual words first. A video recap is not the sitting. A model dump is not the sitting.

Read the words. Audit the design. Name the missing voices. Connect to an amendment. Name a citizen act. That is the full cycle of citizenship in one sitting. The reading is the foundation: you read the actual document. The audit is the understanding: you see the design and its tensions. The missing voices are the honesty: you name who was not in the room. The amendment is the hope: you see the republic can change. The citizen act is the practice: you do something. The citizen who can run this cycle in the age of the summary machine has a check. The citizen who only has a feeling about 1776 has a jersey.

Do not let a model write the paragraph. If the model writes it, the name on the page is a lie. Integrity here is the same as every WisdomForge sitting: the try is yours. The tool is second. If MINE is empty — no sentence in their hand — redo or disclose.

You are not asked to love 1776. You are asked not to fake having read it. You are not asked to hate 1787. You are asked to see the machine, including the ugly gears.

Young capstone. Name one thing a citizen does (read, name, speak, vote) and explain why it matters. You are not too young to read the documents. You are not too young to name the gaps. You are not too young to speak. The voting comes later. The rest starts now. Keep it to one thing. The point is the practice, not the list.

Adult capstone. Run the full cycle once, at the table, with the child. Read. Audit. Name a missing voice. Connect to an amendment. Name a citizen act. Out loud. On one document. The child who sees it will know citizenship is something you do, not something you have. If they say “I’m not political”: citizenship is not a party. It is the practice of reading your founding, naming its gaps, and acting as a member of the republic.

If they say “This is a lot for one sitting.”: The first time, it is. The cycle is the investment. The second time is faster. The third is a habit. The cycle is the capstone. The capstone is the proof that the citizen can practice, not just study.

If they say “We’ll figure it out as we go.”: That is how you get a leak. Spec first — here, the spec is the page.

If they say “I’m too young to be a citizen.”: You are not too young to read. Voting waits. The rest does not.

The capstone artifact is the cycle on paper, not a feeling of having studied civics. If the paper has a founding sentence, a named tension, a cited missing voice, a numbered amendment, and one act you will actually do, the sitting happened. If the paper has a fluent paragraph a model could have written in twelve seconds, the sitting did not happen even if the fluent paragraph is “right.”

Young’s one act is enough for 11–14. Emerging’s five-step cycle is the high-school job. Adult’s table cycle is the inheritance: the child sees it once. Do not skip the young act because you are doing the full cycle. The act is the last step, not extra credit. If you will not vote, do not name vote. Name read. Name speak. The honesty is the citizenship.

Transfer from *How to Think*: claim and check is chapter 1. Steel-man is what you owe a grievance you dislike. Change-your-mind is Article V. Transfer from *Rhetoric in the Age of Fluency*: ethos, pathos, logos against a machine that can fake all three. Transfer from *Education in the Age of AI*: the try is first; the tool is second; “the agent did it” is not a defense. Do not convert those packs. Name the muscle they share.

If they say “I’m not political.”: Citizenship is not a party. It is the practice of reading your founding, naming its gaps, and acting as a member of the republic. You can do that without a platform. If they say “We’ll figure it out as we go.”: that is how you get a leak. Spec first — here, the spec is the page.

“We the People...” — Constitution of the United States, Preamble

People. Not a tool. Not a recap. People who read.

The Big Idea. Read, audit, name the missing, connect to change, act. The full cycle of citizenship. The reading is the foundation. The action is the citizenship.

Integrity. The citizen act must be real. Do not name an act you will not do. The honesty is the citizenship.

Dinner. What full citizenship cycle did we run this week, and what is our act?

Practice

1. Read one founding document or section (Declaration opening, Constitution preamble, or an article). 2. Audit: CLAIM / EVIDENCE / DESIGN / TENSION. 3. Name the missing voices: who was not in the room? Cite one real text if you have it from chapter 4. 4. Connect to an amendment: which amendment closed a gap? 5. Name one citizen act: READ / NAME /

SPEAK / VOTE. Something you will actually do. 6. If a tool helped, say so on the page. If the page was skipped, do not mark complete.

Reflect

If the only civic act you will actually do this month is read, is that a small citizenship or the only honest one — and what would make you upgrade it without lying?

Six labs, one week (optional map)

Use this only if the chapters already ran. It is not six extra sittings.

Lab 1 — Words. One paragraph. Write what it says. Three adds or drops. One ugly clause.

Lab 2 — Argument. CLAIM / EVIDENCE / CONCLUSION. One strong grievance. One weak. Ethos / pathos / logos after you point.

Lab 3 — Design. One article. One check. Three-fifths in your hand.

Lab 4 — Room. Two missing voices. One real text. Founding sentence and missing-voice sentence on one page.

Lab 5 — Change. Article V in your words. Three amendments. Gaps they closed. One gap they did not.

Lab 6 — Cycle. Read, audit, name, connect, act. Real act. Disclose the tool.

If you skip a day, do not stack two labs to “catch up.” One first hand is the week.

| Practice | First hand | Tool, if any | |---|---|---| | Words | Paragraph without interpretation | Summary as a catch, not the source | | Argument | Audit on the page | Labels after you point | | Design | Open an article | Explain-the-design, not a list | | Room | Cite a real missing voice | Recap often skips them — that is data | | Change | Article V plus three amendments | List of 27 is trivia | | Capstone | Full cycle on paper | Model does not write the paragraph |

Fifteen-to-eighteen will meet founding recaps in search, in class, and in models whether you install Hermes or not. This booklet does not make that safe. It makes a check you can run. Safety theater is not the sitting. The sitting is the page and the gap.

If they hide a tool, that is the miss even when the recap is “right.” If they refuse the tool for a week and still read the page, that week is complete. If they refuse the page, that week is not.

Transfer: Thinking (source before summary; missing voices; change-your-mind), English (Rhetoric in the Age of Fluency — same three appeals), CS (the Constitution as a spec with a refuse-list). Keep those as dinner pointers, not extra chapters. Do not convert those packs.

Three seats, one law

Young, emerging, and adult sit on the same six slugs. Little does not. This table is the live sitting, not a second curriculum. Use it when you need the other seat's words without opening a different booklet.

Sitting 1: 'words-before-story'

young. *The Words Before the Story* — Before anyone tells you what the Founders meant, read what they wrote. The words are first. The story is second.

Objective: The student can read one sentence from the Declaration of Independence, write what it actually says, and distinguish that from what a summary says it says.

Big idea: Read the words before the story. The summary adds and drops. The gap is the lesson. Name the ugly gaps too.

Dinner: What words did we read today from the founding, and what did the summary miss?

Integrity: Do not cite a model summary as the source. The words are the source. The summary is the model's compression. Cite the document.

Hard edges: Do not sermonize the Founders. Read the words, including the ones that are ugly by today's standards. The Declaration says 'all men.' It did not mean all people. That gap is real. Name it, do not erase it.

emerging. *Primary Text, Not Storybook* — A republic requires citizens who have read the documents. Not summaries of the documents. The documents.

Objective: The student can read a paragraph from the Declaration or Constitution, write what it says without interpretation, compare it to a model summary, and name three additions or deletions.

Big idea: A republic requires citizens who read the documents. Not summaries. The ugly clauses are in the document. Read them.

Dinner: What did the founding document say this week that the summary did not?

Integrity: Cite the document. Do not cite the model summary as the source. The document is the source. The summary is a compression. Label both.

Hard edges: Do not let the student skip the reading. The reading is the sitting. The Constitution contains the three-fifths clause and the fugitive slave clause. When you reach them, read them. Do not skip. Name what they are.

adult. *Read the Document With Them* — If you argue from a recap, your child will argue from a recap. Read one page of the document with them. Words first.

Objective: The adult reads one page of a founding document with the child, writes what it says without interpretation, and models that citizens read the source before the summary.

Big idea: Read the document with the child. Words first, summary second. Read the ugly parts too. The reading is the citizenship.

Dinner: What page of the founding did we read together this week, and what did the words say?

Integrity: Do not skip the ugly clauses. Do not present a summary as the document. The reading is honest or it is propaganda. Choose honest.

Hard edges: Do not sermonize the founding. Read the words, including the ugly ones, when you reach them. Do not outsource the reading to the model. The model is a summary machine. The reading is yours.

Sitting 2: 'declaration-rhetoric'

young. *The Declaration as Rhetoric* — The Declaration is not just a list of complaints. It is a speech. It uses ethos, pathos, and logos. Read it that way.

Objective: The student can identify one example of ethos, pathos, and logos in the Declaration of Independence and explain how each appeal works.

Big idea: The Declaration is a speech. It uses ethos, pathos, and logos. Read it as rhetoric, not just as history.

Dinner: Which appeal in the Declaration was strongest, and which was weakest?

Integrity: Do not present the model's analysis as yours. If you asked the model to find the appeals, cite it. Your analysis is yours. Its analysis is the check.

Hard edges: Do not reduce the Declaration to a rhetoric exercise. It is also a historical document. The rhetoric is one lens, not the only one. The model can do this analysis if asked. The point is that the student does it first, then checks.

emerging. *The Declaration as Argument* — The Declaration is an argument: a claim (we have the right to independence), evidence (the list of grievances), and a conclusion (we are independent). Audit it.

Objective: The student can deconstruct the Declaration into claim, evidence, and conclusion, evaluate the strength of the evidence, and name one weakness in the argument.

Big idea: The Declaration is an argument. Audit it: claim, evidence, conclusion. Name the strengths, the weaknesses, and the missing voices.

Dinner: What did we find when we audited the Declaration this week?

Integrity: Cite the document. Name the strengths and the weaknesses. The honest audit is the citizenship. The one-sided audit is propaganda in the other direction.

Hard edges: Do not make this a takedown of the Declaration. The point is the audit, not the verdict. The audit might find the argument strong. The grievances include exaggerations and omissions. Name them. The naming is the audit.

adult. *The Declaration at the Table* — The Declaration is a speech your child should hear read aloud, at least once, by a person who means it. Read it.

Objective: The adult reads the Declaration of Independence aloud at the table, names one appeal and one weakness, and models that citizens read the founding as rhetoric and argument, not as scripture.

Big idea: Read the Declaration aloud at the table. Name one appeal and one weakness. The child hears it as a speech, not as scripture.

Dinner: What did we hear when the Declaration was read aloud this week?

Integrity: Name a weakness. If you only name strengths, the reading is propaganda. If you only name weaknesses, the reading is cynicism. Both is the reading.

Hard edges: Do not sermonize. Read the words. Name one appeal and one weakness. Stop. If the child asks about the gap between 'all men' and the reality, answer honestly. Do not dodge.

Sitting 3: `constitution-design`

young. *The Constitution Is a Design* — The Constitution is not a list of rules. It is a design for a government. It says who has power, who checks it, and who can change it.

Objective: The student can name the three branches of government, describe one power each has, and explain how one branch checks another.

Big idea: The Constitution is a design: three branches, checks and balances. The design is brilliant. The compromises are ugly. Both are the document.

Dinner: What part of the Constitution's design did we see today, and what compromise did we name?

Integrity: Do not present the model's summary as the Constitution. Read the articles. The design is in the text, not in the summary.

Hard edges: Do not make this a civics memorization drill. The point is the design, not the list. The three-fifths clause is part of the design. When you reach it, name it. It is not a bug. It was a compromise.

emerging. *The Constitution as Architecture* — The Constitution is architecture: a structure of power, checks, and amendment. Read it as a design, not as a list of rules.

Objective: The student can describe the Constitution's architecture (separation of powers, checks and balances, amendment process), identify one design tension, and explain why the design matters for citizenship.

Big idea: The Constitution is architecture: separation, checks, amendment. See the design. Name the tensions. The understanding is the citizenship.

Dinner: What part of the Constitution's architecture did we understand this week, and where is it under strain?

Integrity: Cite the Constitution. Name the architecture and the tensions. Do not present a model summary as your reading. The text is the source.

Hard edges: Do not make this a worship of the design. The design is brilliant and flawed. Name both. Academic integrity: cite the Constitution, not a model summary. The text is the source.

adult. *Read the Design With Them* — If you do not understand the design of your government, the child will not either. Read one article of the Constitution with them. See the design.

Objective: The adult reads one article of the Constitution with the child, names one design feature and one tension, and models that citizens understand the architecture of their government.

Big idea: Read one article of the Constitution with the child. Name one design feature and one tension. The design is the citizenship.

Dinner: What article did we read this week, and what did the design show us?

Integrity: Name the tension. If you only name the brilliance, the reading is propaganda. If you only name the ugliness, the reading is cynicism. Both is the citizenship.

Hard edges: Do not sermonize. Read the article. Name the feature and the tension. Stop. Do not skip the ugly parts. The three-fifths clause is in the design. Name it.

Sitting 4: 'missing-voices-founding'

young. *Who Was Not in the Room?* — The Declaration said 'all men.' The room did not have women, enslaved people, or Indigenous people. The gap is the history.

Objective: The student can name one group whose voice was missing from the founding documents and describe how the document would have been different if they had been in the room.

Big idea: The founding was written by a room that did not include everyone. The gap between the words and the room is the history.

Dinner: Who was not in the room when the founding was written, and how would it have been different?

Integrity: Do not ask the model to speak for the missing voices. The model cannot. The missing voices are in real people, real texts, real histories. Find those. The model is a summary, not a voice.

Hard edges: Do not make this a dismissal of the founding. The point is honest reading, not rejection. Keep it concrete: name one group, describe one difference.

emerging. *The Founding and the Missing* — The founding documents claim universality and were written by a partial room. The gap between the claim and the room is not a footnote. It is the central tension of the republic.

Objective: The student can identify the gap between the founding documents' universal claims and their partial authorship, name two missing voices, and find one real source for a missing voice.

Big idea: The founding claims universality and was written by a partial room. The gap is the central tension. Find the missing voices. Read them.

Dinner: What missing voice did we find this week, and what did it say back to the founding?

Integrity: Cite the real text for the missing voice. Do not cite the model as the source for the voice. The model is a summary. The text is the voice.

Hard edges: Do not reduce the founding to its gaps. The point is reading both the document and the gap. Academic integrity: cite the real source for the missing voice, not the model. The model is not a voice.

adult. *Read the Missing Voice With Them* — The founding is half the story. The missing voices are the other half. Read one, with the child, alongside the founding.

Objective: The adult reads one text from a missing voice (Douglass, Adams, Indigenous speech) alongside a founding document, names the gap, and models that citizenship includes both the founding and the voices it left out.

Big idea: Read one missing voice alongside the founding. The child who hears both has received the whole republic, not half.

Dinner: What missing voice did we read with the founding this week, and what did it say?

Integrity: Cite the real text. Do not ask the model to speak for the missing voice. The model is a summary. The text is the voice. Read the text.

Hard edges: Do not make the missing voice a dismissal of the founding. The point is completion, not rejection. Choose a text the child can handle. Douglass's speech is powerful and direct. Adams's letter is brief. Choose what fits.

Sitting 5: `amendment-process`

young. *The Republic Can Change* — The Constitution was not finished when it was written. It has been changed 27 times. The change is built into the design.

Objective: The student can explain what an amendment is, name one amendment that changed the republic, and describe how the document can change.

Big idea: The Constitution was designed to change. 27 amendments prove it. The republic is a practice, not a relic.

Dinner: What amendment did we learn about today, and how did it change the republic?

Integrity: Cite the amendment and the article. Do not present a model summary as the source. The text is the source.

Hard edges: Do not make this a memorization of all 27 amendments. Name one or two that changed the republic. The 13th, 14th, and 15th amendments are the Reconstruction amendments. They changed the republic after the Civil War. Name them.

emerging. *Amendment as Civic Practice* — The amendment process is the design feature that lets the republic evolve without breaking. The 13th, 14th, and 19th amendments are the republic changing its mind.

Objective: The student can describe the amendment process, name three amendments that changed the republic, and explain how amendment connects to the founding's promise of change.

Big idea: Amendment is the republic changing its design to match its promise. The 13th, 14th, and 19th are the republic changing its mind.

Dinner: What amendments did we read this week, and what gaps did they close?

Integrity: Cite the amendments. Read them. Do not present a model summary as the source. The text is the source.

Hard edges: Do not reduce amendments to a timeline. The point is the practice: the republic changing its design. Academic integrity: cite the amendments. Do not cite a model summary as the source.

adult. *The Republic Is a Practice* — If you treat the Constitution as a relic, the child learns it is dead. Read one amendment with them. Show them the republic is alive.

Objective: The adult reads one amendment with the child, names the gap it closed, and models that the republic is a practice that evolves, not a relic that sits.

Big idea: Read one amendment with the child. Name the gap it closed. The republic is a practice, not a relic.

Dinner: What amendment did we read this week, and what gap did it close?

Integrity: Name the gap. If you read the amendment without naming the gap it closed, the reading is incomplete. The amendment and the gap are one lesson.

Hard edges: Do not make this a political lecture. Read the amendment. Name the gap. Stop. Choose an amendment the child can understand. The 13th (end of slavery) or the 19th (women's vote) are concrete.

Sitting 6: `citizens-capstone`

young. *You Are a Citizen* — You read the words, saw the design, named the missing voices, and learned the republic can change. Now: what does a citizen do?

Objective: The student can name one thing a citizen does (read the documents, name a gap, speak, vote) and explain why it matters.

Big idea: A citizen reads, names, speaks, and votes. The reading is the foundation. The action is the citizenship.

Dinner: What is one thing a citizen does, and why does it matter?

Integrity: The citizen act must be real. 'Read the documents' is real. 'Name a gap' is real. Do not name something you will not do. Name what you will do.

Hard edges: Do not make this a political lecture. The point is the practice of citizenship, not a position. Keep it to one thing a citizen does. The point is the practice, not the list.

emerging. *The Citizen's Full Practice* — Read the words, see the design, name the missing voices, understand amendment, and act. The full practice of citizenship in one cycle.

Objective: The student can run the full citizenship cycle: read a founding document, audit the design, name the missing voices, connect to an amendment, and name one citizen act they will take.

Big idea: Read, audit, name the missing, connect to change, act. The full cycle of citizenship. The reading is the foundation. The action is the citizenship.

Dinner: What full citizenship cycle did we run this week, and what is our act?

Integrity: The citizen act must be real. 'Vote' if you can. 'Read' if you cannot yet. 'Speak' is always available. Do not name an act you will not do. The honesty is the citizenship.

Hard edges: The student must run every step. Skipping is skipping the capstone. The citizen act must be real. 'Vote' if they can. 'Read' if they cannot. 'Speak' is always available.

adult. *The Citizen at the Table* — Run the full cycle once, at the table, with the child. The child who sees it will practice citizenship for life. That is the capstone.

Objective: The adult runs the full citizenship cycle on one founding document in front of the child, names a citizen act, and models that citizenship is a practice, not a school subject.

Big idea: Run the full cycle once, at the table. The child who sees it will practice citizenship for life. The cycle is the republic.

Dinner: What citizenship cycle did we run at the table this week, and what is our act?

Integrity: The citizen act must be real. Name something you will actually do. If you will not vote, do not name vote. Name read. Name speak. The honesty is the citizenship.

Hard edges: Do not make this a lecture. Run the cycle. Talk through the steps. The child watches. The citizen act must be real. Name something you will actually do: vote, read, speak, attend.

For the Grown-Up Reader

Six live academy sittings (`words-before-story` through `citizens-capstone`), young / emerging / adult. Little sitting **404** by design. This high band is the emerging variants in `history-civics.ts`, with young named as the earlier seat so the student can see the hop. Primary text: Declaration of Independence (1776) and Constitution of the United States (1787), including Article I's three-fifths clause, the fugitive slave clause in Article IV, and Article V. Rhetoric lens uses Aristotle's three appeals as named in the sitting, not as a full *Rhetoric* course.

Missing-voice texts cited: Abigail Adams to John Adams, 31 March 1776; Frederick Douglass, "What to the Slave Is the Fourth of July?", Rochester, 5 July 1852. Amendments cited: XIII (1865), XIV §1 (1868), XIX (1920). The Fourteenth remains its own figure booklet. Do not convert it here.

Scholarship named, not assigned as homework except the one Research Prompt: Pauline Maier, *American Scripture* (1997); Danielle Allen, *Our Declaration* (2014); Gordon Wood, *The Creation of the American Republic*; Charles Beard, *An Economic Interpretation of the Constitution* (1913); Akhil Reed Amar on popular sovereignty; Thurgood Marshall's 6 May 1987 bicentennial speech. Do not pretend you read those books in this sitting. Name the fight they mark. The sitting is still the page.

This is not the Hour book. It is not Federalist / Magna Carta / Constitution / Declaration / Fourteenth *figure* booklets. Those remain their own packs. No real family data. Do not clone an adult profile into a child's. Nearby means you can hear the lid. It does not mean you write their sentence.

If you only run one lab this week, run chapter 1's paragraph. Keep the three drops. That gap is worth more than a speech about 1787.

Do not grade their soul. Do not make the model the first read of a live assignment. Do not skip the ugly clauses "until they are older" if you are already reading the pretty ones. The skip teaches that citizenship is only the parts that feel good.

National Archives texts of the Declaration and Constitution are public domain. Read from those, not from a chatbot's memory of them. If your printout and the model disagree, the printout wins. Cite the document. Always the document, never the recap as the source.

If they hide a tool, that is the miss even when the recap is "right." If they refuse the tool for a week and still read the page, that week is complete. If they refuse the page, that week is not. You are not asked to become a constitutional lawyer tonight. You are asked to hear a recap as a recap.

Dinner questions already live on the sittings, keep them. Young: What words did we read today from the founding, and what did the summary miss? Emerging: What did the founding document say this week that the summary did not? Adult: What page of the founding did we read together this week, and what did the words say?

About WisdomForge

This is the high band of *Citizens — Constitution & Declaration*. Payment pulled. No purchase CTA. The booklet is the text. The parent is the teacher. The guide is optional. Not a hosted kids chatbot. Does not make AI safe.

Four ages, one spine. Elementary, middle, and adult bands of this pack are separate files. Little academy sittings stay 404 on purpose. Pair from `/learn/emerging/history/words-before-story`` when you want the live sitting beside this text. Print the page. Pencil first. Tool second.